

AFRIVATE TEAM SPACE — PORTAL USER GUIDE

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Audience	Every team member, lead, People & Culture, and administrator
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Contact	hr@afrivate.org

This guide describes the principal features of Afrivate Team Space and the approved procedures for their use.

Operating principle: Matters requiring a formal record, approval, or acknowledgement must be completed in the Portal. Official broadcasts are issued by email. Learning delivery is provided through Alison. Official internal messaging is conducted through Slack. WhatsApp is reserved for informal or emergency contact only. A Slack message does **not** replace a required Portal record.

1. HOW AFRIVATE USES THIS PORTAL

Tool	What it is for
Portal (Team Space)	The system of record for leave, policies, learning evidence, surveys, recognition, growth plans, memos, appraisals, discipline, PIPs, and employee profiles.
Email (hr@afrivate.org)	Official organisational broadcasts and correspondence. Responses should ordinarily be issued within one (1) working day.
Alison	Course delivery and certificates. Assignments and evidence of completion are recorded in the Portal.
Google Drive	Master copies of policies and contracts. Staff-facing copies are published under Resources .
Slack	Official internal messaging for clarification, coordination, escalation, and reachability during core hours. Official messages must be acknowledged within four (4) hours on official work days. Slack does not replace Portal records.
WhatsApp	Informal or emergency contact only. WhatsApp must not be used for leave requests, policy acknowledgements, appraisals, or formal People & Culture processes.
AVA	Afrivate Virtual Assistant — in-portal help for how-to guidance, policy explanation, and taking you to the correct Portal page. AVA never submits leave, check-ins, learning, approvals, or any other record for anyone. You complete every action yourself.

2. ROLES AT A GLANCE

Role you see	Typical authority
Team member	Access core employee features: tasks, leave requests, learning, surveys, My info, recognition, and growth tools.
Assistant lead	All team-member capabilities, plus leave approval for managed personnel and visibility of team check-ins.
Team lead	All assistant-lead capabilities, plus authority to publish memos and manage calendar events.
People & culture (HR)	Full access to the Admin area, including approvals, leave queues, the HR dashboard, Recruitment, and the Employee hub.
Administrator	All People & Culture capabilities, plus authority to change roles and administer departments and teams.

Leads ordinarily have visibility of personnel linked through reports-to, team-lead, or department-head relationships.

3. GETTING ACCESS

Request access

1. Open **Request access** on the login screen (</request-access>).
2. Enter your name, work email, password, department, and job title.
3. Submit the request. Access remains pending until People & Culture or an Administrator approves it under **Admin → Approvals**.

Sign in

1. Go to </login> .
2. Sign in with email and password, or use a magic link if offered.
3. If the account remains pending, a waiting state is displayed until approval is granted.

Forgot or reset password

1. Use **Forgot password** (</forgot-password>).
2. Open the email link and set a new password on </reset-password> .
3. Sign in again.

Account & security

- Open **Account** (</account>) to change email or password.
- Read the privacy notice anytime at </privacy> .

4. FINDING YOUR WAY AROUND

Main sidebar

Menu item	Where it goes	What it is for
Home	/	Personal overview and priority actions
My work	/tasks	Assigned and owned work
Inbox	/inbox	Notifications
People	/people	Leave, shout-outs, learning, surveys, growth, My info, directory
Search	/search	Organisation-wide search across permitted records
Weekly update	/checkin	Weekly operational check-in
Getting started	/onboarding	Onboarding videos and checklist
Notes	/notes	Shared notes and knowledge pages
Memos	/announcements	Organisation and team announcements
Resources	/documents	Policies, handbooks, templates
Calendar	/events	Events calendar
Admin	/admin	Restricted to People & Culture and Administrators

On mobile devices, the primary navigation presents **Home**, **My work**, **Inbox**, and **People**.

People hub tabs

Inside **People** you will see: Overview · Time off · Shout-outs · Learning · Surveys · Growth · My info · Directory.

5. HOME

Path: Home (/)

Home presents a personal overview and items requiring attention:

- Tasks due, leave waiting on you (if you are a lead), unread memos, today's events
- Banners for open surveys, learning due, or policies that need acknowledgment
- Early onboarding progress if you joined recently

Procedure: Select a card or banner to open the relevant page. Review recent memos and mark them as read upon completion.

6. MY WORK (TASKS)

Path: My work (/tasks)

Track personal and assigned work with status, priority, due dates, categories, hours, and blockers. When someone marks a task complete, the portal stores **who** completed it and **when**.

Procedure:

1. Filter by Mine / Owned / Assigned, status, priority, or category.
2. Switch views (board, list, week) if available.
3. Create a task: title, description, assignees, due date, estimate, hours, blockers.
4. Move status: To do → In progress → Done (or Blocked).
5. Open a task to log activity or mark **Complete**.

7. INBOX & SEARCH

Inbox

Path: /inbox

Shows notifications (shout-outs, assignments, mentions, and similar). Open an item to mark it read and jump to the related page. Use **Mark all as read** to clear outstanding notification indicators.

Search

Path: /search

Enter a name or keyword. Results can include people, memos, tasks, documents, events, leave, shout-outs, surveys, learning, OKRs, and (for HR) recruitment and related HR records. Visibility respects your role.

8. WEEKLY UPDATE (CHECK-IN)

Path: Weekly update (/checkin)

Each week, share what you finished, what is next, blockers, and hours worked. You can usually set visibility (department or wider).

Procedure:

1. Open **This week** / submit form.
2. Fill the fields and submit (you can update the same week later).
3. Use **History** for your past weeks.
4. Leads use **Team** to review their people's updates. HR can also review org-wide under **Admin** → **Check-ins**.

9. GETTING STARTED (ONBOARDING)

Path: Getting started (/onboarding)

For new joiners: welcome videos and a checklist.

Procedure: Complete the assigned videos and checklist items in sequence. People & Culture manages videos and checklist items under **Admin** → **Onboarding**.

10. NOTES

Path: Notes (/notes)

Shared pages for meeting notes, plans, and knowledge.

Procedure: Create or edit pages, set sharing to team or private as appropriate, and delete only where authorised and confirmed.

11. MEMOS (ANNOUNCEMENTS)

Path: Memos (/announcements)

Company and department updates with priority, categories, and optional attachments. Some digests mirror what HR also sends by email.

Procedure:

1. Browse and filter memos; open to read and mark as read.
2. **Team lead and above** can compose or edit memos (drafts may save on your device before publish).
3. Set audience and priority; attach files when needed.
4. HR/Admin can moderate and delete; HR can draft digests from the HR dashboard.

12. RESOURCES (DOCUMENT LIBRARY)

Path: Resources (/documents)

Handbooks, policies, and templates. Some documents require you to **acknowledge** that you have read them.

Procedure:

1. Browse or search by category.
2. Open, preview, or download.
3. If a policy requires acknowledgment, complete that action (Home and People will remind you).
4. HR uploads and manages documents, categories, and flags (requires acknowledgment, HR-only, management-only).

13. CALENDAR (EVENTS CALENDAR)

Path: Calendar (/events)

Team events in month / week / day / agenda views. A Google Calendar view may appear if configured.

Procedure: Browse events and open details. **Team lead and above** can create and publish events (all staff or a department). Drafts may save locally before you publish.

14. PEOPLE HUB — DAY-TO-DAY PEOPLE TOOLS

Overview

Path: /people

Shortcuts into leave, shout-outs, learning, surveys, growth, My info, and directory. Leads and HR also see team or org snapshot cards and action banners.

Time off

Path: /people/leave

This is the **official** leave channel (annual, sick, emergency, and related types).

How to request leave:

1. Click **Request leave**.
2. Choose dates, type, and reason.
3. Attach a supporting document if needed (for example a medical note).
4. Submit and track status under **My requests**.

How leads / HR approve:

1. Open **Team requests** or **All requests** (HR), or use **Admin → Leave**.
2. Approve or decline with a note.
3. Use the calendar tab to see time off at a glance.

Shout-outs

Path: /people/shout-outs

Peer recognition tied to values or tags. Submit recognition entries, respond with likes or comments where appropriate, and share within permitted channels. People & Culture administers recognition tags.

Learning

Path: /people/learning

Monthly Alison assignments and certificate proof.

1. Open the assigned Alison course.
2. When finished, submit course name, completion date, and certificate.
3. Track pending / approved / rejected.
4. HR publishes assignments and reviews submissions (also from the HR dashboard).

Surveys

Path: /people/surveys

Pulse surveys, eNPS, and onboarding surveys. One response per person feeds HR metrics. Open an active survey, answer the questions, submit. HR launches surveys from templates, sends reminders, and reviews results under **Admin → HR dashboard**.

Growth

Path: /people/growth

Performance and voice tools in one place:

Tab	Purpose
OKRs	Quarterly objectives and key results
1:1s	Monthly manager check-ins (meet outside the portal; mark complete here)
IDP	Individual development plan — write, submit, respond to manager notes
Feedback	360° forms when a cycle is open
Milestones	Day 30 / 60 / 90 onboarding checkpoints
Awards	Quarterly award visibility
Speak up	Confidential grievances

Managers mark 1:1s complete for their reports. HR reviews IDPs, opens feedback cycles, resolves grievances, and runs awards from Admin.

My info

Path: /people/my-info

Your personal details for the Employee Information Hub.

What you can update: Preferred and legal name, personal email, phone, work location, country, date of birth, pronouns, LinkedIn, bio, skills, emergency contact, and next-of-kin notes.

What you cannot change yourself: Employment status, engagement type, probation dates, payroll flags, and other HR-only fields. Those live under **Admin** → **Employees**.

Procedure: Complete the form, review the completeness indicator, and select **Save**. Where People & Culture requests a review, a reminder banner is displayed.

Directory

Path: /people/directory

Search the team, open profiles, see availability, and contact colleagues. Edit your own profile card; HR/Admin can edit others when needed.

15. ADMIN — FOR PEOPLE & CULTURE AND ADMINISTRATORS

Path: Admin (/admin) — HR and Admin roles only

Approvals

Review pending access requests. **Approve** (set role, department, job title as prompted) or **Deny**. Invite a member by email when needed.

Recruitment

Applicant tracking for open roles: criteria, Gmail sync from the HR mailbox, ranking, stages (applied through hired/rejected), CV preview, search, and rescoring. Connect Gmail via the OAuth flow when prompted.

Users

View and edit people (department, job title, active flag, reports-to). **Only Administrators** can change roles. You cannot deactivate your own signed-in account.

Departments & Teams (Admin only)

Create and maintain departments (optional head) and teams (lead, assistant lead, department link).

Announcements

Moderate org-wide memos from Admin when needed.

Leave

Org leave queue and calendar-style review — approve or decline pending requests.

Onboarding

Manage welcome videos and checklist items for Getting started.

Check-ins

Org-wide weekly check-in digest.

HR dashboard

People operations overview covering headcount, engagement, eNPS, learning, 1:1 rate, leave, grievances, surveys, attrition, time-to-hire, policy acknowledgments, OKRs, recognition, onboarding CSAT, **active PIPs**, **pending discipline**, and **probation due**.

From here you can also:

- Export KPIs
- Assign Alison courses and review certificates
- Launch pulse / eNPS surveys and remind non-responders
- Manage awards, IDP review, policy acknowledgments, exit interviews, grievances
- Open 360° feedback cycles and manage templates
- Draft an HR digest memo
- Adjust portal labels (categories and tags)
- Open the Revival launch checklist if you are on the allowlist

Employees (Employee Information Hub)

System of record for profiles, progressive discipline, PIPs, appraisals, probation, and offboarding.

Directory

Search active people by engagement type, employment status, and profile completeness. Open a **dossier** for full detail.

Person dossier

- Set engagement (employee / volunteer / contractor) and status (active, probation, leave, exiting, terminated, archived)
- Record start date, probation end, confirmation, payroll setup, contract or volunteer terms
- Keep HR-private notes (these stay off the default PDF)

- **Request employee to update My Info**
- Review discipline history and open a new case
- **Export PDF** (optionally include discipline) and **Archive** when appropriate

Discipline & PIP

Follow AfriVate's progressive ladder:

1. Coaching / verbal
2. Written warning
3. Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)
4. Restricted duties
5. Termination case

Record severity, trigger (for example missed deadlines, communication, absence, misconduct, underperformance), and how it was delivered (portal notice, meeting, email, letter).

- **Activate (HR)** or save as a **pending recommendation** for HR approval
- Approve pending items in the queue (termination remains carefully gated)
- For active PIPs: track goals and review cadence, mark on track, and close with passed / extended / escalated / terminated recommendation
- Creating a PIP step can auto-create a PIP with templated goals and duration

Appraisals

Formal appraisals use **60% output / deliverables** and **40% soft skills / behavioural**. Scores roll into an overall percentage and band (Exceptional, Good, Performance concern, Disciplinary, Termination consideration — as configured in the portal). Cadence is typically quarterly, or monthly while someone is on an active PIP. Save, finalize, and keep history on the person's record. Pair with the branded Performance Appraisal Form when you need a printable worksheet.

Probation

See upcoming probation end dates and **Confirm** employees into active status with confirmation metadata.

Lead scorecards

Track lead quality signals such as delivery consistency, KPI completion, communication discipline, and escalation quality.

Offboarding

Start a checklist with a reason. Default items cover completing or reassigning Portal tasks, final check-in, knowledge transfer, revoking access (email, Slack, Portal), collecting assets, exit interview notes, and volunteer Code of Conduct bridge notices when relevant. Tick items as done.

Audit

Chronological log of HR actions on profiles, discipline, PIPs, appraisals, and offboarding.

16. AVA — AFRIVATE VIRTUAL ASSISTANT

Where: Purple AVA button (bottom-right on desktop; above the mobile nav on phones)

AVA is the official in-portal help assistant for Team Space. She explains how to use the Portal, summarises key policy rules, and can take you to the page where you complete an action.

What AVA can do

- Answer how-to questions (leave, learning, weekly updates, tasks, surveys, My info, Slack rules).
- Explain which tool is correct (Portal vs Slack vs WhatsApp).
- Show a **Go to...** button that opens the right Portal page (for example Time off, Learning, Weekly update).
- Use your own Portal snapshot (open tasks, leave status, surveys) to give personalised guidance.

What AVA cannot do

- Submit, approve, reject, edit, or delete any Portal record for anyone.
- Draft a leave request or weekly check-in that gets saved for you.
- Replace People & Culture decisions or Slack acknowledgements.

Procedure

1. Select **AVA**.
2. Ask a question or choose a suggested prompt (for example "How do I request leave?").
3. Read the steps. If a **Go to...** button appears, select it to open that page.
4. Complete the action yourself in the Portal.
5. Close AVA with the close control or Escape.

If AVA is unavailable, open **Resources** for the Portal User Guide and policies, or contact hr@afprivate.org.

17. REVIVAL LAUNCH CHECKLIST (SPECIAL ACCESS)

Path: /launch-checklist (also linked from the HR dashboard)

Only named launch owners can open this. It is a shared playbook for portal readiness, memos, WhatsApp drafts, Alison, surveys, town halls, and related launch work. Check off tasks, edit drafts, and track progress as portal actions complete.

18. QUICK “WHO DOES WHAT” CHEAT SHEET

Need	Where
Request leave	People → Time off (or ask AVA → Go to Time off)
Approve leave	People → Time off (leads) or Admin → Leave (HR)
Acknowledge a policy	Resources (or Home banner)
Submit weekly update	Weekly update (or ask AVA → Go to Weekly update)
Submit learning completion evidence	People → Learning (or ask AVA → Go to Learning)
Complete an open survey	People → Surveys
Update emergency contact	People → My info
Locate a colleague	People → Directory or Search
Get how-to help inside the Portal	AVA (navigate-only; you complete the action)
Publish an organisational memo	Memos (team lead+) or Admin → Announcements
Manage recruitment pipeline	Admin → Recruitment
Record a PIP or appraisal	Admin → Employees
Change a user role	Admin → Users (Administrator only)

19. RECOMMENDED WEEKLY PRACTICE

1. Begin at **Home** and address outstanding banners (surveys, learning, policy acknowledgements).
2. Record leave and formal People & Culture matters in the **Portal** — not in WhatsApp or Slack.
3. Mark tasks **Complete** in My work so completion time and actor are recorded.
4. Submit the **Weekly update** before the reporting period closes.
5. Maintain complete **My info** records to minimise administrative follow-up.
6. Use **Slack** for official internal messaging. Use the Portal whenever a formal record, approval, or acknowledgement is required.
7. Use **AVA** when you are unsure where to go — then complete the action yourself on the page she opens.

For access or People & Culture enquiries, contact hr@afprivate.org or your designated People & Culture representative.